

A small useful city network

Start with one El Segundo host, one weekly bulletin and one monthly table. Expand only when local people want it, a venue agrees, and the workload remains comfortable.



PROPOSED SHARED SPACE

The community counter

NOUNS MAIL connects a city page, a printable noticeboard and a five-minute audio bulletin. A shared cafe or studio corner offers seats, a printer, a kettle and a place to make postcards. The room belongs to a consenting host; these visuals do not identify an actual leased or endorsed business.

The money desk

NOUNS MONEY is the proposed shared-cost ledger and budget explainer. It records approved project expenses and receipts, with private details removed. It is not a bank, deposit service, wallet, currency or investment offer. No funds are committed by this plan.

The first decision

Find a willing accountable host and a suitable existing space before buying equipment or announcing a gathering. If those conditions are absent, run a small online editorial test and keep physical plans clearly marked proposed.

The weekly and monthly rhythm

A dependable small service should be easy to understand, easy to join and easy to stop. This is a proposed publishing schedule, not a calendar invitation or reservation.

A five minute weekly bulletin

00:00-00:30: what changed and any corrections. 00:30-01:15: courts and recreation, with current source links. 01:15-02:00: two verified local events. 02:00-02:45: a swap and a borrowing request. 02:45-04:15: one consented local story or light entertainment segment. 04:15-05:00: the next table, accessibility details and how to submit or correct an item.

A workable editorial week

Monday: invite short submissions. Tuesday: verify sources, consent and expiry dates. Wednesday: record and edit. Thursday at 09:00 in each city: proposed release of audio, transcript and a printable one-page bulletin. Friday: correct errors and expire stale listings. Release time is a planning default that hosts can change.

Small online meeting

Second Wednesday each month, proposed 30 minutes at 17:00 America/Los_Angeles / 20:00 America/New_York. Check local time conversion when publishing each event. Open with one useful question, allow text participation, end with the next small action. No default recording and no attendance requirement.

One local table each month

Proposed third Saturday, 10:00-12:00 local time, only after host and venue approval. Start with six to twelve seats, postcards and a noticeboard. Publish cost, step-free access, restroom access, sound levels, capacity and cancellation status. Walk-ins only if the host permits; a quiet seat should be available.

A humane production limit

Aim for one editor session of 90 minutes, one verification session of 45 minutes and one audio session of 45 minutes per week, spread across willing people. These are workload estimates, not compulsory shifts. If the team cannot cover the work, publish text only or skip an edition and say so.

January through June 2027

Each month is a decision gate. A missed gate moves the next phase later; the calendar is not a promise to open locations.

January / Listen before launching

Ask prospective El Segundo hosts what would genuinely help. Collect ten voluntary expressions of interest, identify an accountable organizer, and write a one-page scope. Do not publish participant names or a venue before consent.

February / Agree the pilot

Obtain written host and venue permission, review safety and accessibility, agree capacity and expenses, and test the editorial workflow. Set a spending ceiling and identify who can authorize reimbursements. If there is no suitable host, remain online.

March / Publish four test editions

Run an opt-in online El Segundo bulletin with transcripts and source dates. Gather corrections and record whether anyone completed a useful action. Run one short online conversation. Real-world table remains conditional on venue readiness.

April / Try one table

If all launch gates pass, run one two-hour El Segundo table with an approved accessible venue, a named contact and a clear end time. Provide postcards and art stamps; participants apply actual postage and mail letters themselves.

May / Make the routine comfortable

Repeat only what helped. Track workload, accessibility requests, completed swaps and unresolved complaints. Trial a printer or mic only if borrowed equipment cannot meet demand. Preserve a simple text-only fallback.

June / Decide whether to continue

Review eight weeks of useful outcomes and organizer capacity. Continue, simplify or pause El Segundo. Publish a short redacted cost report. Invite LA host interest only if the existing pilot is healthy; make no new-city opening promise.

July through December 2027

El Segundo remains the reference pilot. Los Angeles and New York are separate host-led proposals with their own consent, demand, budgets and accessibility checks.

July / Package the starter kit

Release the template bulletin, print sheets, consent wording, moderation guide and source manifest. A prospective LA host can run a private tabletop rehearsal. No address or public launch date is posted before approval.

August / Optional Los Angeles test

Only a ready LA host runs four digital test editions and one approved table. Otherwise improve the El Segundo kit. Share an editorial checklist across cities, while local hosts retain responsibility for accuracy and room operations.

September / Optional New York rehearsal

A willing New York host tests the city page, local verification and a time-zone-friendly online session. They need their own venue consent and local operational review; LA readiness does not imply New York readiness.

October / Optional New York table

If every gate passes, hold one modest NY table. Test a shared online bulletin exchange featuring a short original story from each active city. Do not open a continuous radio service or promise daily programming.

November / Keep the useful parts

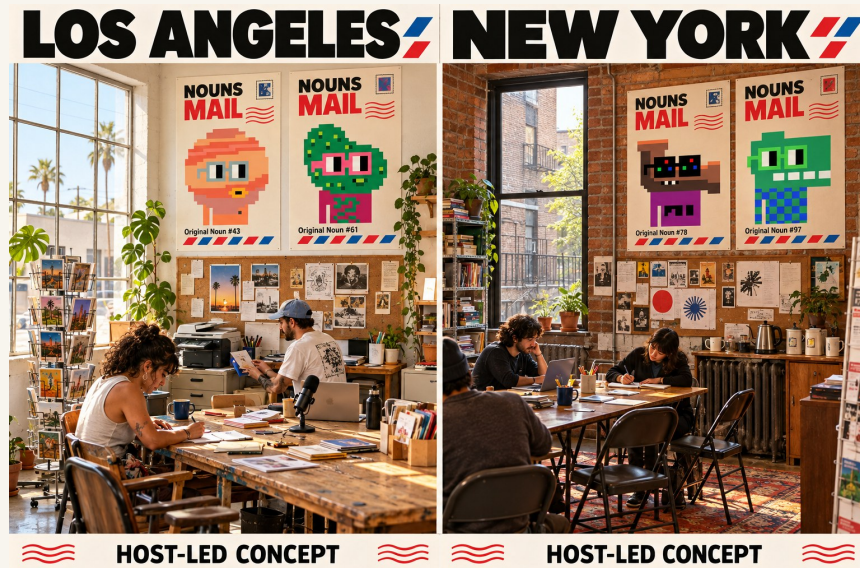
Compare completed local actions, host effort, costs and safety feedback. Remove unused categories and stale entries. Offer one short cross-city online meeting if local hosts want it. Pause a city when cover or consent lapses.

December / Decide on 2028

Publish a plain-language pilot review with redacted costs and participant feedback. Ask each host whether to renew, change or stop. Archive inactive city pages with their status and last-updated date. No automatic expansion or renewal commitments.

A shared room within reach

Use an existing room, borrowed equipment and short host-approved sessions. The estimates below are planning assumptions in USD, not quotes or spending authorization.



Illustrative starter equipment

Printer \$150-300; microphone and headphones \$80-180; kettle and reusable cups \$40-80; noticeboard and basic stationery \$40-100; second-hand or borrowed seating \$0-200. Equipment subtotal: \$310-860. With a 20% contingency: \$372-1,032 per city. Borrow first; buy only after approval.

Illustrative monthly cash costs

Shared-venue contribution \$0-250; paper and art printing \$30-90; tea and water \$20-60; basic online hosting/tools \$0-40; access support reserve \$50-150. Monthly subtotal: \$100-590. With 20% contingency: \$120-708. Three active pilot months plus setup: \$732-3,156 for one city.

What these figures leave out

These are not an all-in operating budget. Excluded: a full lease, deposits, buildout, staff or contractors, insurance, permits, taxes, legal review, shipping, postage and music licenses. Obtain those costs where applicable before launch; the access reserve may be insufficient for a specific request.

A transparent spending routine

Choose a named budget owner and a second receipt checker. Approve purchases before anyone incurs costs; publish category totals rather than personal payment data. Disclose sponsorships and avoid membership or donation commitments until the organizer, terms and handling process are agreed.

Roles and safeguards

Optional participation should remain genuinely optional. This operating proposal does not establish a legal entity or determine worker status; local review is a prerequisite where needed.

Bounded roles with a clear exit

Host: one monthly table and venue coordination. Editor: one edition at a time. Verifier: check a small set of dated links. Audio contributor: one original clip. Access contact: check stated arrangements and route requests. Each role has an agreed end date and an easy opt-out. Do not rely on unpaid people to replace required paid work; review the actual arrangement under applicable rules [2].

Consent and editorial rights

Get explicit permission before recording or publishing names, faces, voices or stories; allow a non-recorded route. Avoid collecting children's information. Use original, public-domain or properly licensed audio and record permissions for every track. An online bulletin does not confer broadcast rights. Any terrestrial-radio plan needs a separate licensing and technical review [3].

Privacy and moderation

Collect the minimum contact data for the stated purpose. Separate private addresses and organizer contact details from public listings. Define access, deletion and retention before launch; a proposed default is to delete RSVP contact data 30 days after the event unless someone separately opts in. Remove expired listings. Provide reporting, correction and appeal routes with named coverage.

Safe and accessible participation

Use a conduct policy, a consented venue contact and an emergency procedure. Do not publish home addresses, payment details or allegations. Moderate swaps and borrowing for scams, dangerous or regulated items and coercion. Publish text transcripts, captions where relevant, readable contrast, keyboard-friendly pages and alternative contact methods. Confirm physical access rather than promising it from a rendering.

Clear limits for mail and money

Every art stamp must say ART STAMP - NOT POSTAGE. Real letters require valid postage and correct addressing; check current carrier rules at mailing time [1]. This pilot does not accept custody of mail or offer forwarding, deposit-taking, cash exchange, lending, investment advice or money transfer services. Refer those needs to suitable authorized providers.

An open kit with useful measures

Make the format easy to reuse while letting each city remain local. The digital page connects people; the table gives them a comfortable place to meet.



Starter kit version 0.1

Include editable art-stamp, envelope, postcard and noticeboard templates; authentic Noun source IDs and provenance; city-page fields; audio script and transcript format; consent/rights log; moderation workflow; budget template; access checklist; host handover and pause guide. Propose open licensing for original kit text/code after confirming contributor rights. Nouns artwork is CC0; using it does not confer token ownership or endorsement.

A common record and a local owner

Every listing needs city, category, title, source URL, source-checked date, expiry, public contact route, consent status and an accountable editor. Event entries also need local timezone, accessibility facts and confirmed/proposed/cancelled status. Export simple JSON/CSV and a printable view. Never put private RSVP data in that export.

Measure usefulness before adding cities

Review completed helpful actions, accuracy/corrections, repeat voluntary participation, access requests met, cost per useful outcome and organizer hours. Proposed expansion gate: eight reliable weeks, two willing local stewards, renewed venue consent, covered costs and no unresolved serious incident. These are decision thresholds to test, not achieved results. Followers, token prices and city-count growth are not success measures.

Sources checked 2 October 2026: [1] USPS letter and postcard guidance. [2] US Department of Labor Fact Sheet 14A. [3] FCC low power FM guidance. Art: original Nouns #43, #54, #61, #78, #83 and #97 from the supplied verified canonical source set; nouns.wtf. Visuals are AI-generated proposals using those references, not photographs of operating locations.